

Use this guide to make household accounts and devices harder to take over, and to know what to do if an account is compromised. Do not write passwords on this worksheet.

Secure the accounts that matter most

- ☐ Use a unique, long password for each important account; consider a reputable password manager.
- ☐ Turn on multi-factor authentication (MFA) for email, banking, shopping, social media, and cloud storage.
- ☐ Secure your primary email account first; it is often used to reset other accounts.
- ☐ Keep recovery phone numbers and recovery email addresses current and accessible.
- ☐ Review sign-in alerts, connected apps, active sessions, and account-recovery settings.
- ☐ Do not share passwords, one-time codes, recovery links, or backup codes with anyone.

Protect devices and information

- ☐ Turn on automatic updates for phones, computers, browsers, apps, and routers where available.
- ☐ Use screen locks and device encryption where supported; enable "find my device" features.
- ☐ Back up important documents and photos using a secure method, and test that you can restore them.
- ☐ Pause before opening unexpected links, attachments, QR codes, or login prompts.
- ☐ Verify requests by using a website, statement, or phone number you find independently.
- ☐ Use separate guest Wi-Fi for visitors or smart devices if your network supports it.

Account security record

Do not write passwords

Account or service	MFA on?	Recovery contact stored where	Last review / action needed

If an account may be compromised

Act quickly

1

Secure your email first. Change its password, turn on MFA, review recovery details, and sign out of sessions you do not recognize.

2

Change affected passwords. Use new, unique passwords; remove unknown devices, apps, rules, forwarding settings, and payment methods.

3

Contact the service or bank. Use official support channels and report unauthorized activity promptly.

4

Protect your devices. Update software, run security checks, and remove untrusted apps or browser extensions.

5

Watch for follow-on scams. A person claiming to “recover” your account may be another scammer. Never share codes or payment information.

Recovery and device log

Date / time	Account or device	What happened / action taken	Reference no. / next step

PASSWORD MANAGER / SECURE RECORD LOCATION

TRUSTED ADULT OR ACCOUNT-RECOVERY CONTACT

BACKUP / IMPORTANT-FILE LOCATION

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Call 911 if a compromised account or device puts someone in immediate danger. Otherwise, report scams to the platform and, if money or identity was involved, to the FTC at [ReportFraud.ftc.gov](https://www.ftc.gov/report-fraud) and [IdentityTheft.gov](https://www.identitytheft.gov).